

including
**International UFO
Reporter!**

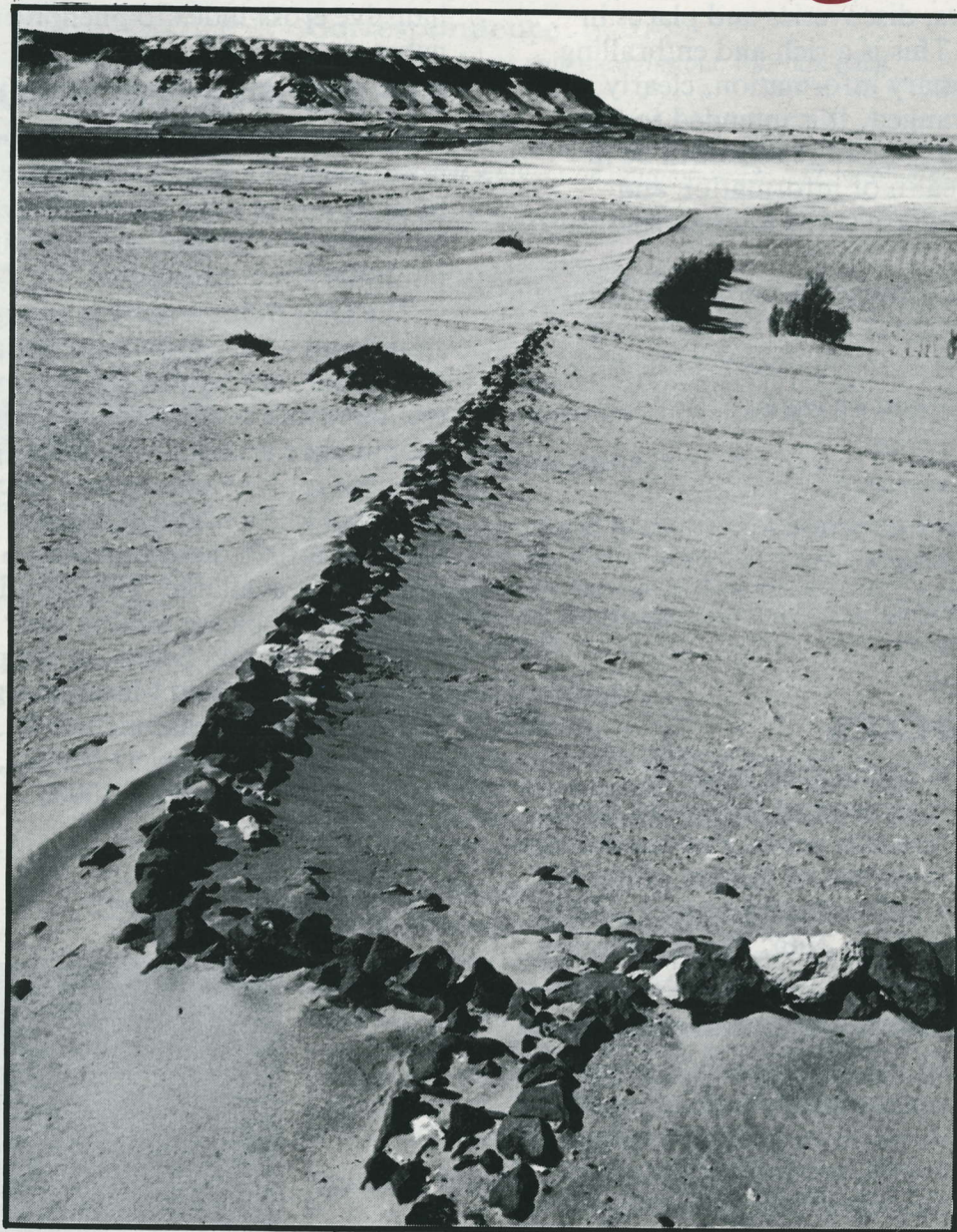
January-February 1981

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FRONTIERS of SCIENCE

Saudi Arabia's Megaliths



I SEE UFO!
*The UFO
Investigator's
Primer of Look-
ing and Seeing*

**New Age
Healing —
Homeopathy,
Radionics and
Touch**

**SETI: Silly,
Extravagant,
Toadying,
and Unintelligent**

Von Daniken Strikes Again...New Life Origin Theory...Killer Waves...Antibiotics B.C....
Turn Your 'Ears' Off, Sagan!

Sightings and Encounters

INTERNATIONAL



REPORTER

These reports are gathered and authenticated through the Center for UFO Studies in Evanston, Illinois, for which Allan Hendry is Chief Investigator. The Center maintains a 24-hour UFO Hotline for the exclusive use of U.S. law enforcement agencies, Federal Aviation Agency facilities, planetaria and other formal channels. The Center also maintains contact with the news media and individual correspondents throughout the world. It also cooperates with the Mutual UFO Network and other UFO investigation groups. Additionally, the Center maintains a computerized databank (UFOCAT).

—A.H.

Tumbling Daylight UFO

TYPE: DD

DATE: October 6, 1980

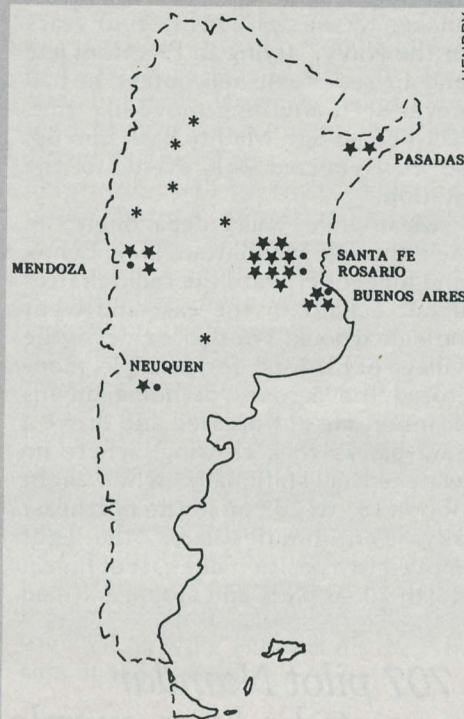
TIME: 5:50 p.m. EDT

WITNESS: 2

PLACE: Ipswich, Massachusetts

A sixty-year-old retired equipment troubleshooter, outdoors on a sun deck, noticed sunlight flashing on this silver, circular form. Thinking it was only an airplane coming in from the east over the sea, he noted that it was tumbling end-over-end. Running inside for his wife, he brought out 7x50 binoculars and watched as the object passed overhead. Its angular size *with* the binoculars was similar to one quarter that of a full moon (or sun). The form continued westward, appearing to descend as it disappeared behind the trees toward the Sagamore Hill Radio Telescope Installation.

The witnesses called veteran investigator Ray Fowler, who checked with a variety of agencies within a half-hour of the sighting. These included the Ipswich and Essex police, the U. S. Coast Guard, the FAA at Beverly Airport and Pease Air Force Base. No other reports had been made, however. The witnesses saw the form pass in front of clouds which were officially at eight thousand feet. Winds were from the northeast, but the five-knot speed seems much too slow to propel the form at the speed noted.



UFO interest grows in Argentina. Stars show locations of the eighteen member groups of the Argentine Federation. Asterisks show locations for six other important groups.

A Spiralling Daylight Cigar

TYPE: DD

DATE: November 2, 1980

TIME: 3 p.m.

DURATION: 16 minutes

WITNESSES: at least 12

PLACE: downtown Vallejo, California

Mike Clampett, a thirty-year-old Westinghouse engineer, and his wife were shopping for a new car. That's why they stepped out of a Toyota showroom on Solano Avenue in time to see a crowd of people looking up at the "absolutely clear" sky. It seemed as if a Piper Cub were on a collision course with a silver "cigar" or "blimp." The plane was moving north to south while the UFO flew silently from high in the eastern sky to the west. The angular size, though less

than the sun ($1/2^\circ$), was large enough to see that there were no wings on the form. Clampett couldn't tell whether the bright glare of light from its surface was due to reflection or self-illumination. This glare made it hard to study the outline carefully. It could be seen, though, that the form was rotating and spiralling about once every second.

It took nearly ten minutes for the form to reach a position nearly overhead, dropping in altitude all the while. Eventually it became clear that the UFO was flying much higher than the plane as it passed above it. The silver cigar remained stationary near the zenith for about five minutes. Then, as if in answer to any notions that it was only a balloon propelled by the wind, it adopted a new southbound course, climbing higher as it flew at a "very fast" speed. Indeed, it closed the distance from the zenith to the horizon in only one minute.

Curiously enough, no other reports are extant from the area. A check with the San Francisco Interna-

KEY TO ABBREVIATIONS

A "UFO" is any anomalous aerial phenomenon whose appearance and/or behavior cannot be ascribed to conventional, natural or man-made sources after study by analysts who possess technical qualifications the original witness(es) may lack.

Abbreviations used in this section follow six categories of UFO reports developed by Dr. J. Allen Hynek:

NL: Nocturnal Light. Any distant anomalous source (usually illuminated) seen in the night sky.

DD: Daylight Disc. Any distant objects (often disc-shaped) seen under daylight conditions.

RV: Radar/Visual. UFOs seen simultaneously by vision and radar; good agreement between the two is essential.

CE I: Close Encounter of the First Kind. UFO seen within five hundred feet.

CE II: Close Encounter of the Second Kind. CE I that influences the environment, including physical traces, physiological effects and electromagnetic interferences.

CE III: Close Encounters of the Third Kind. CE I or II associated with creatures ("UFO-nauts").

tional Airport indicated no word from the pilot alleged to be in the area. Similarly, a popular UFO reporting service in the northwest had no corroborating reports.

UFOs—or IFOs Over Joliet?

TYPE: NL

DATE: November 25, 1980

TIME: 3:30 a.m.

DURATION: 3 hours

WITNESSES: many

PLACE: environs of Joliet, Illinois

Chicago-based news media heavily publicized this event because of the number of law enforcement officers who watched it from separate locations. The reader will note, however, that the significance of the event is controversial at best.

The stage was set the evening before, when a nineteen-year-old resident of New Lenox walked into the Will County Sheriff's Department at 11:05 p.m. An officer took down his report of two green light sources, one larger than the other, which he viewed from his bedroom window. The lights moved back and forth in the southern sky and even disappeared briefly as a plane flew beneath them. Unfortunately, the witness had his phone temporarily disconnected following the report and more details were not available on a first-hand basis at press time. The report, for example, has the witness start viewing the "UFOs" at 10:50 p.m. for "twenty minutes" ... which doesn't fit with the time he entered the Sheriff's Department.

Hours later, two members of that Sheriff's Department—Lt. Sicinski and Sgt. Mau—were headed south on Bridge Street. They knew of the earlier UFO sighting. Mau directed Sicinski's attention to a light in the eastern sky about 15° to 30° up. The lieutenant thought it was just the white landing light of a plane on approach a couple of miles away. But then it became clear that the light wasn't getting anywhere. Seen at a crossroads some three quarters of a mile south, the light appeared to be drifting horizontally south. The lawmen drove further south, watching the light drift slowly in the east alongside of them for five to ten min-

utes. When they made it to a Commonwealth Edison plant, the light source performed its most remarkable stunt. It shot off to the south-southeast sky and came back again to the east-southeast in less than a second. Sicinski reported being quite shaken by the sight. In his "four years in the Navy," flying in Phantom jets and air/sea rescue helicopters, he had never seen anything move like this. Yet he had Sgt. Mau to back him up, so he reported the event to the station.

Meanwhile, police departments in neighboring Manhattan, New Lenox and Joliet overheard the radio chatter about a light in the east and went outside to look. The police chief of the village of Ellwood, for example, monitored the account at home on his scanner. He got dressed and drove a few blocks to a clearing, where he watched a stationary white light about 15° to 20° up in the northeast sky. Ten minutes later, the light moved to a position due east of him in 15 to 20 seconds and stopped. It had

707 pilot Namdar reported a huge, purple form passing below him at 'amazing speed.' Suddenly, the cabin was flooded with brilliant yellow light.

also climbed about 10° in elevation and dimmed while moving. Now it was fluctuating in brightness as if clouds were passing in front of it.

The police chief watched the "UFO" remain stationary for five to ten minutes more. Then it started moving slowly south on a level flight toward the southeast sky. All of this was very slow, however. At 5:40 a.m., he tried driving east toward it for three miles without gaining on it.

It was at this point that the "UFO" stopped behaving like a true Nocturnal Light and more like Venus. Lt. Sicinski sat in a jeep and lined up the now-motionless light through the diamond-shaped rung of a nearby cyclone fence. Forty-five minutes later, the light had climbed *upward* out of the rung in the eastern sky, just as Venus would behave. It also surprised Sicinski to learn that another

deputy watching the light some twenty-five miles east of him was *also* looking east to see it. This placed it much further away than he had guessed.

Finally, the light didn't disappear from sight until sunrise! A newsman from WJOL radio saw the light when he came to the station at 5 a.m. to routinely examine the police log for news. Consequently, local coverage of the story was available almost while the light was still visible! The newsman went out the next morning and was convinced he was looking at the same thing the next day—Venus. Yet Sicinski and Mau remain steadfast about their joint observation that the light they watched jumped nearly halfway across the sky and back again.

Other claims, including a "landing" and "hundreds of witnesses," were not readily substantiable. Checks with the FAA at Chicago's O'Hare Airport and the Aurora Air Route Traffic Control Center failed to yield any corroborative information.

Vehicle Affected By Mini-UFO?

TYPE: CE II - EM

DATE: December 3, 1980

TIME: approximately 8:30 p.m. CST

DURATION: 10 seconds

WITNESS: 1

PLACE: McLain, Mississippi

Janice Lowrey's husband was driving and didn't see the UFO in question, but he certainly testifies to the unusual effects that immediately followed his wife's sighting.

The couple was driving north on Highway 57 to visit Mrs. Lowrey's sister. When they were about ten miles south of McLain, with no other traffic in this undeveloped, rural area, Janice, nineteen, saw an illuminated ball to the east. The ball slowly approached the car at the woman's eye level. Finally, it came briefly over the right side of the car's hood. Mrs. Lowrey feared it would collide with the windshield.

At a distance of only three feet, the ball looked to be twelve inches in diameter. It seemed to be self-luminous, yet appeared solid and distinctly outlined. It was not so bright that it lit up the hood, however. The sphere was white with a blue tint in the center. No sound could be heard.

The small form did not hit the car. Instead, it turned very rapidly back to the east, moving so quickly that Mrs. Lowrey could not follow its motion through the clear sky. It simply seemed to vanish.

Robert Lowrey, twenty-five, didn't see the object buzz them from the right. He believes his wife's account, though, because of the following changes in the performance of his 1977 Monte Carlo:

- The heater quit working. Mrs. Lowrey thought she could still hear the blower fan. Mr. Lowrey couldn't.
- The seat belt buzzer came on. By tugging on the seat belts for ten minutes, the Lowreys made the noise stop. There is just one mystery about this: Mr. Lowrey notes that he removed the annoying buzzer when he first acquired the car. He also asserts that there is no other buzzer in the car that makes that distinctive sound.
- Their FM-radio, tuned to WQID in Biloxi, stopped producing sound, except for what Mrs. Lowrey described as the noise of "weak, multiple stations." They turned off the radio shortly after it cut out. A check by IUR with WQID's engineering staff revealed that they had not gone off the air at that time.
- Of chief concern to Mr. Lowrey was the dimming of his headlights. Even with the brights on, they could hardly see two feet in front of the car.
- The horn didn't work. Yet despite all of these electrical troubles, his V-8, 305 cubic-inch engine worked fine, electronic ignition and all.

These effects persisted for the 25-minute drive to their destination in Beaumont. Yet when Mr. Lowrey came out to check the car a half-hour after they parked it, everything worked fine. Lowrey said that the Monte Carlo, purchased (used) eight months prior to the incident, was the "best car we ever owned." No similar problems had been noticed before or since the event. Lowrey, formerly an auto mechanic who ran a service station for four years, can't locate any problems in the car now.

Cloud UFOS?

If you live anywhere from Illinois to Florida, you may have recently seen a strange glowing cloud, twice the diameter of a full moon in the early evening sky. To be exact, you would have spotted one on December 4, 6, 8, and 12. That's when Eglin Air Force Base in Florida launched them! They were barium clouds, huge volumes of glowing ionized gas launched high above the earth by rocket. The purpose this time: to test the effect of ionized gases on communication with satellites.

The unintended effect of such launches was the generation of false "UFO" reports in areas where the news media didn't get the explanation to the public. The Center for UFO Studies even received calls from as far north as central Illinois. Indeed, a member of CUFO's Scientific Board was on a plane over Kentucky on the 12th when the pilot asked over the intercom: "Are there any scientists on board who can tell us what the unusual glowing cloud is on the left side of the plane?"

Foreign Forum

The editors cannot exert the same "first-hand" control over foreign cases as domestic ones. However, it is certainly of value, at least, to compare the reported characteristics of the phenomenon abroad with sightings in the United States. — A.H.

Estimate of the Argentine UFO Situation

Dr. J. Allen Hynek returns from a UFO conference in South America with this report:

The frequent occurrence of international UFO conferences (or "congresses") in various parts of the world attests to the global extent of the UFO phenomenon. Generally sponsored by one or more study groups in a given country, they are often well attended by the public and the UFOphiles alike.

The recent UFO congress held in Mendoza, Argentina from December 5 to 7, 1980, the "Segundo Congreso Internacional de Ciencia Extraterrestre," is a current example. It was sponsored by the Argentine Federation for the Study of Extraterrestrial

Science, a fairly recent and very serious attempt to unify UFO study groups in Argentina. Eighteen organizations adhere to the Federation, but this still leaves about a dozen organizations that wish to maintain full independence. The Federation exercises no direct control over the work or policies of its component members.

The name of the Federation illustrates the almost universal identification of the UFO phenomenon with extraterrestrial intelligence. To my way of thinking, this imposes a limit to the full breadth of investigation. A particular theory of a phenomenon should not be confused with the phenomenon itself.

Argentina has many broad, open spaces, and the clustered groups are not uniformly distributed within them. Buenos Aires, which has about one-third of the population of the entire country, has only three member organizations (and some small independent groups). The relatively small city of Santa Fe, on the other hand, has eight (see map).

The member organizations can be generally characterized by the youth of their participants. UFOs seem to be a young people's concern in Argentina. These groups are polarized by their philosophies and objectives, leading to the opinion of some that the Federation cannot truly succeed. While some groups profess a scientific approach to UFO study, an equal number stresses the "metaphysical" or mystical approach. At present, their outlooks are incompatible. Some groups have avoided becoming Federation members because of the presence of the metaphysical groups, fearing the loss of their scientific image. On the other hand, these "scientific" groups boast no professional scientists, though most of them number professional people among their members.

Unlike the United States, the UFO groups are numerous but of small membership...vanishingly small in some cases. This tendency has been ascribed to the individuality of the Argentinians, who want to think for themselves. A more compelling reason is political: It seems that any group, social, political or otherwise, is viewed with suspicion by the government. Groups of fifty or more must be officially registered with the government and are subject to surveillance.

The open expanse of the country

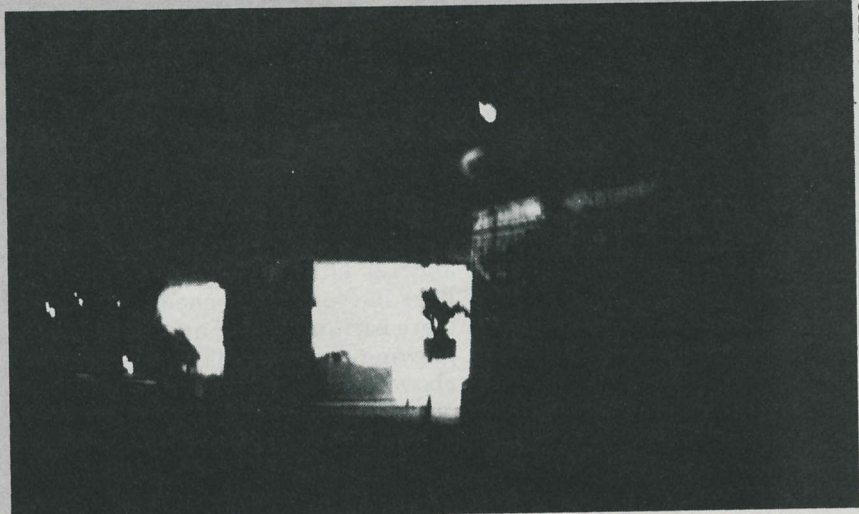
and the universal lack of funds strongly militate against proper investigation of UFO reports. Intentions are excellent, but the means for carrying them out are poor. Still, interest in UFOs by the general Argentine population runs high, and interesting reports abound.

The papers presented at the three-day meeting in Mendoza reflected a varied scope of philosophies. Representative subjects included.

- the mysterious cloud of June 14, 1980 (see *Frontiers of Science*, September-October 1980), noted and observed over a very wide geographic area;
- a contributed paper by Len Stringfield on the perennial subject of crashed saucers and retrieved cadavers;
- a contributed paper by Dr. Leo Sprinkle on his psychological investigation of contactees;
- and a paper on elemental nature spirits (fairies, little people, etc.) which has only a vague possible connection with the entities reported in close encounters of the third kind.

One of the more perceptive papers by Ricardo Funes from Neuquen, Argentina stressed that the study of the UFO witness should take precedence over the study of the case. My own paper, among other things, called for a professional approach to the study of UFOs, without which no better data will be garnered in the next decade than has been accumulated in the past decade. One positive approach to which I was introduced was the Argentine equivalent of UFOCAT, the Center's own computerized UFO data catalog. Devised by an IBM executive in Buenos Aires, this computer data bank files and creates statistics on close encounter cases only.

The concept of the Federation is a good one and sets a fine example for other countries. It attempts to overcome differences and rivalries among member groups without impeding their individualities. We wish the Argentine Federation much success.



NORBERTO CASTRO

Photograph of the luminous cloud-like halo seen over South America last June. In a brief span of time, the high-altitude UFO moved over thirteen degrees of arc, ruling out the theory that it was a barium cloud launch.

Jet Hunt for Australian UFOs

TYPE: RV
DATE: December 4, 1980
TIME: 8 a.m.
DURATION: 3 hours
WITNESSES: many
PLACE: Perth, Australia
SOURCE: *The Melbourne Sun*, December 6, 1980, via Paul Norman

Graham Moyle, an air traffic controller at Perth Airport, was the first to notice "silver tumbling discs" in the daylight sky. He and other controllers would make two or three visual sightings through 11 a.m. that morning. Ellis Keil, the regional director of transport, said these discs were tracked on radar at a height of more than 8000 meters until they disappeared at more than 20,000 meters. A Macchi jet was scrambled by the RAAF, but the pilot could not find the UFOs. No aircraft or balloons were known to be in the area.

An independent witness to the event may be twelve-year old Danielle Russell who reported seeing four objects moving quickly north to south at 11 a.m. Watching them through a window, she thought they were birds or aircraft until they changed colors, from red to blue to green.

The RAAF announced it is investigating the matter. They have already issued a loose statement, however, suggesting "unusual atmospheric conditions" resulting from a sudden onset of hot weather could somehow

be responsible for the radar/visual daylight sightings. IUR hopes to secure more details on this perhaps significant event.

Review of Iranian UFO Reports

Apart from the much-publicized "F-4 interceptor" incident of September 18, 1976, little is known about current UFO reporting activity in Iran. Somewhat to our surprise, IUR has developed an unimpeded correspondence with Bahman Rouhizad on UFO reports in that country. Based on translations of local press accounts, Mr. Rouhizad has enabled us to present a brief review of the characteristics of unusual aerial phenomena being reported there in the last four years.

1976

Most of what we know about the September 1976 attempt to scramble two jets after a luminous UFO originated from a military dispatch (acquired through the Freedom of Information Act). It was known from the outset, however, that the Iranian press covered the event locally. According to *Etellaat* magazine, one of their reporters obtained a copy of dialogue that occurred at the Teheran Airport Control Tower. The magazine asserted that a woman spoke with the tower about midnight on Sunday, September 18 as follows:

Woman: "For about an hour I have seen a strange object above my house and since my husband is on a trip, I am getting fright-

ened. Please advise whether you are aware of it, and know what it is? Please help me, I am very scared."

Tower: "Lady, do not get frightened, we just sighted the object at an altitude of six thousand feet and will investigate. Please do not worry, we shall pursue the matter."

The officer in charge contacted Shahroukhi base and asked for a jet to be sent to identify the object. The test on tape of the pilot's report is as follows:

Pilot: "Control Tower, this is Phantom Pilot 'J.' I just sighted the subject which is radiating very bright orange, purple and white colors and is going toward south Teheran with speed a few times faster than my jet. The brightness of the colors is three times more than the moon seen from the earth."

Tower: "In case you see no chance to reach the object, please return to the base."

Pilot: "OK, I am returning, but it seems that now the object is following me with a tremendous speed. Now it is fifteen miles from me...ten...now only five miles. Help, help, it may destroy the jet...The object passed me. Please guide me to return to base."

This time, the control tower sent another Phantom to follow the object. At 2 a.m., the UFO was sighted about ten miles south of Tehran. The pilot got close to the light and tried to fix a Phoenix missile on the UFO.

Second Pilot: "Another smaller object separated from the object and is going down to the desert. This 'ship' is so bright that I can see the sands on the ground... The small ship left the ground and joined the object. Now it is leaving the Tehran area with a tremendous speed."

The article concluded that people living in the area were attracted by the sound of the Phantoms and looked out to see the UFO. The smaller UFO that detached itself from the main one had an estimated diameter of four to five meters.

This magazine account differs in various respects from the military dispatch. In that scenario, the first jet is not chased by the UFO. System

difficulties forced the jet to return. Also, the article doesn't mention a luminous form that was "fired" at the second jet. This projectile had to be dodged by the pilot as his weapons system froze. Then the projectile returned for a "perfect rejoin" with the UFO. The smaller UFO dropped down to the desert afterward. The time and location of the second scramble agree with the military dispatch, however.

1977

Most of the sightings originated from Iran's huge salt desert, about half a million square kilometers in extent. During mid-March, twenty to twenty-five objects were noted by Teheran's Mehrabad Airport to be flying from the desert toward the city. These were described as yellow in color by the pilot and passengers of an Iranian flight at 10 kilometers altitude, 140 kilometers from Teheran. A Japanese pilot the same distance south of the city switched on all his lights when he saw a huge object ahead of his plane. Reportedly, fifteen to twenty objects flew out of the original object toward the pilot, who changed course and headed for the Teheran airport.

On May 13 at 4 a.m., a sixteen-year old noticed his second-floor room strangely brightened. He assumed it was a plane until he looked out the window and watched an unusual object with "unexplainable" color. Picking up a camera, the Iranian teenager took one unclear picture of the object. The same boy would claim taking three more pictures of three objects moving in a triangular fashion on June 26 at 4 a.m. The Shirazi family also claimed to see the same colorful sight at the same time.

On June 28, a few people in Teheran reported seeing a strange object which was later confirmed on radar in Teheran with no further explanation. Another incident involved a man with a flat tire between Abadan and Ahwaz. The heat from a "huge, bright object" which changed from red to green to purple and blue gave him the impression of closeness. Then its lights went off. As the witness sat in the car to sleep, the light returned, even closer. He thought it would fall on his car. When he turned off all his car's lights, the luminous form again was extinguished.

The last event noted in the press involved a Mr. A. Shojacei. For forty-five minutes, he reported watching a

large strange form partially covered with very thick fog.

1978

On June 11 at 10:30 p.m., Captain Namdar, the pilot of a 707 in flight from Shiraz to Teheran, was descending to 25,000 feet over Isfahan airspace. He reported a huge, purple form passing below him at "amazing speed." The luminous object's speed and agility convinced the pilot and co-pilot it was no aircraft. When they contacted the airport for radar confirmation, however, they received none.

Suddenly, the plane's cabin was flooded with brilliant yellow light radiating from two sources. This illumination felt as hot as "a sunny day in summer in Spain." Their electric and magnetic pointers were fully turned in the direction of the lights. This purple source continued to follow the plane until a portion of the UFO separated from it and moved toward the southeast side of the witnesses (reminiscent of the 1976 incident). Then the light from the original source vanished.

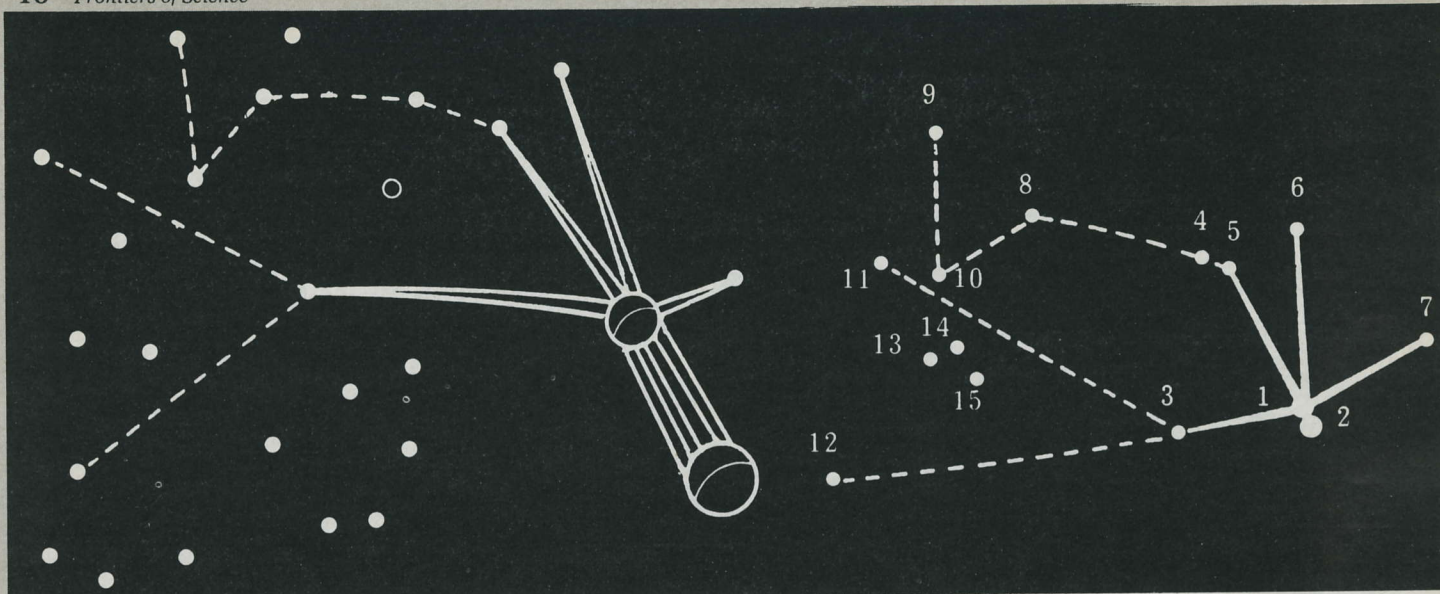
Captain Namdar had more than seven thousand hours of flight experience. He expressed familiarity with meteors, ice crystal clouds and satellites. The pilot has reported UFO sightings on two other occasions.

1980

The early weeks of June found the Iranian press reporting almost daily on unknown "star-like" objects with yellow, orange, pink and greenish colors. These were noted mainly at the south and west borders of Iran. By this time, the Iranian guards had come to suspect a trick at the hands of the United States or Iraq, and were opening fire on the lights.

Our last report from our correspondent stemmed from a Kayhan newspaper account based on a Passdaran (Revolutionary Army) official report. On September 12, a bright round object radiating red and white colors from all sides was reported as a UFO south of Bojnord in northwest Iran. This luminous object had been moving "very fast" for one hour over the city.

It's impossible, of course, to come to any hard conclusions based on



LEFT: Betty Hill's original star map. RIGHT: Marjorie Fish's interpretation of fifteen of the stars: 1) Zeta 1 Reticuli; 2) Zeta 2 Reticuli; 3) Gliese 86; 4) Tau Ceti; 5) 82 Eridani; 6) Sun; 7) Alpha Mensae; 8) 107 Piscium; 9) Gliese 67; 10) 54 Piscium; 11) Tau 1 Eridani; 12) Gliese 59; 13) Gliese 95; 14) Kappa Fornacis; 15) Gliese 86.1.

such scanty press accounts. One suspects many of these events have natural explanations. Yet at a time when activity within Iran dominates our news media on a daily basis, it is certainly of interest to observe that neither rain, nor snow nor revolution seems to stand in the path of UFO reporting activity.

UFO Newsfront

Update on the Betty Hill Star Map

Viewers of the PBS television series "Cosmos" saw host Carl Sagan talking about UFOs last December 14. The focus of his attention was the alleged CE III abduction of Betty and Barney Hill. Many readers are undoubtedly aware of Mrs. Hill's controversial "proof" for this alien visitation: the memory of a star map showing the origin of the UFO-nauts in space. When the forgotten details of Betty Hill's abduction were explored under hypnosis two years after her experience, she recalled being shown this three-dimensional map by one of her humanoid captors. All the alien implied about the map was that it contained our sun and his home star. After coming out of hypnosis, Mrs. Hill drew the map on paper. Her map showed twenty-six stars (ranging in size from a "pin-point" to a "nickel"). Twelve of these

stars were connected by solid and dashed lines deemed to be trade routes and exploratory paths.

After the drawing was published, schoolteacher Marjorie Fish constructed a three-dimensional model of all known stars within forty-five light years of the sun using beads and string. With all of these points to go on, no obvious pattern of stars emerged that would conform to the drawing. It was not until all of the stars unlike our own sun (including close binary—or twin—stars) were removed that a pattern similar to the twelve key stars with travel routes appeared. When the *Gliese Catalog of Nearby Stars* was published months later, three more stars—two of them sunlike—fit the Hill drawing for the first time. The implication was that the Hill map could not have been faked on the basis of previous astronomical knowledge.

Sagan's argument on television matched his earlier one in print. Remove the helpful solid and dashed lines from the Hill map and the Fish interpretation, and the resemblance between the remaining dot patterns breaks down. Given the freedom to rotate your point of view in space, Sagan argued, you could find many patterns that, in theory, should match the Hill pattern even better.

The fallacy in this argument, reasoned Terence Dickenson, editor of *Star and Sky* magazine, is that the analysis must be extended to three-dimensional space. Of the more than 100 stars in the specified 74,000 cubic light-years containing the Fish interpretation, all of the single, sunlike

stars go into forming the pattern of 12 stars connected by trade routes. Two additional sunlike stars fit two of the unattached dots and a fifteenth star—Zeta Tucanae—would be blocked from view by the Zeta Reticuli pair. Furthermore, the lines connecting the key stars are sensible travel patterns in three-dimensional space from Zeta Reticuli. No backtracking is encountered from one star to the next in three dimensional space. Thus, the enthusiasm of UFO proponents on this matter was not unreasonable.

Yet while one astronomical publication served to support the value of the map, another, more recent, appears to sink it ... or at least the Fish interpretation. Writing in the *Astronomy and Astrophysics Supplement Series* (42, 185-188, 1980), D. Bonneau *et al* report on their use of speckle interferometry, a recent and powerful technique for resolving binary stars too close to be separated by conventional optical means. The astronomers report having split five "stars" into binary pairs for the first time ... and one of them was Zeta 2 Reticuli! They note that astronomers DaSilva and Foy suspected earlier this year that it would turn out to be a binary star on the basis of their high-dispersion spectral studies. DaSilva and Foy predict that Zeta 1 Reticuli will also be shown to be a close binary by the speckle method.

Why is this important? For one thing, the stars corresponding to Zeta 1 and 2 Reticuli in Mrs. Hill's map were quite prominent in size.

Continued on page 29

Fitzgerald from page 4

beacon, which had been automated, was not working, and he could not get a radio fix on his position. At no time did McSorley, a mariner with a fine reputation among his peers, show great concern over the condition of his vessel in talking over the radio-telephone with Captain Cooper of the *Anderson* or with others.

The consensus of lake mariners is that the *Fitz* "holed" herself on Caribou Shoals, took water in from the fracture along the ship's bottom, and, as a result of the locally violent weather conditions, foundered. The Coast Guard investigators looked

upon hatch cover conditions — specifically a form of a gasket fitting around the single-piece hatch cover — as a contributing cause. This view has not been well received by the mariners who have spent a lifetime sailing the lakes. Their theory is that the vessel, which lies in three parts on the bottom of Lake Superior broke either as the bow struck bottom, or while the vessel was in the act of sinking. It is difficult to imagine taconite pellets "jamming the pumps."

It sounds as though Mr. Metz has spent too much time reading newspaper accounts and not enough time in reading the various reports writ-

ten many months after the disaster and subsequent investigations. So far as "the truth about" the *Fitz* is concerned, nobody — not even the Coast Guard — knows why or how she sank. A viewing of the eighteen hours of underwater television film made by the Coast Guard showing the wreck would tell him why no one knows.

Richard J. Wright, Director
Center for Archival Collections
Bowling Green State University,
Bowling Green, Ohio.

IUR from page 16

Why would the Reticulans inaccurately depict their home sun(s) as singular on their own navigational plots?

The other problem was stated by Terence Dickenson, ironically at a time when the two stars were thought to be single: "If stars are too near each other, they can't have planets in stable orbits suitable for the development of life over billions of years." That's the reason why Marjorie Fish excluded them from her own considerations.

We don't yet know for sure if these binary pairs are sufficiently close to preclude stable planetary orbits. Yet the depiction of Zeta 2 Reticuli (and probably Zeta 1) as single stars in the Fish interpretation alone seems to be its downfall. And without a meaning-

ful interpretation, the Hill star map has no intrinsic probative value.

CIA Suit Supported By Fund

The Fund for UFO Research has awarded a \$2,500 grant to underwrite the appeals litigation in a Freedom of Information Act lawsuit against the CIA (see the September-October & November-December 1980 *Frontiers of Science*). The legal action seeks copies of two hundred known UFO documents yet to be made available by the CIA. The documents were identified from references in nearly a thousand pages of material previously released by the Agency under court order. □

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